

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO
UNIFIED FAMILY COURT

ROSEANNE BULAONG,

Petitioner

VS.

STEVEN BASTUBA,

Respondent

) Case Number: FDI-24-800746

) Hearing Date: May 21, 2026

) Hearing Time: 9:00 AM

) Department: 403

) Presiding: JUDGE KATHLEEN DIESMAN

REQUEST FOR ORDER RE: BIFURCATION AND SEPARATE TRIAL (STATUS-ONLY OF
DOMESTSIC PARTNERSHIP)

TENTATIVE RULING

Having read and considered the pleadings, declarations, and other evidence submitted in this matter, the
Court makes the following findings and orders:

A. Procedural History

- 1) The parties are Petitioner Roseanne Bulaong and Respondent Steven Bastuba.
- 2) On 3/20/26, Respondent filed a Request for Order seeking bifurcation and termination of domestic partnership status. Respondent attached form FL-315 (Request for Separate Trial). Respondent states he pays \$200 dollars for Petitioner's health insurance and requests the Court exercise its discretion to impose conditions under Family Code section 2337(c) related to Petitioner's health insurance.
- 3) On 4/28/26, Petitioner filed a Responsive Declaration agreeing to bifurcation and termination of domestic partnership status so long as Respondent continues to be financially responsible for Petitioner's health insurance.

B. Findings and Order

- 1) Public policy favors bifurcation and termination of domestic partnership status.

1 2) The Court finds that Respondent's request for bifurcation of the parties' domestic partnership
2 status is unopposed.

3 3) Based on the pleadings filed with the Court and signed under penalty of perjury, the Court further
4 finds that:

5 a. Petitioner filed a Petition for Dissolution of Domestic Partnership on 12/20/24.

6 b. Under Family Code section 2339(a), the Court first acquired jurisdiction over Respondent
7 when Respondent was served with the Petition and Summons on 1/3/25. See Proof of
8 Service of Summons filed 1/15/25.

9 c. Respondent filed a Response and Request for Dissolution of Domestic Partnership on
10 5/2/25.

11 d. Within the Petition and Response, both parties indicate that Respondent was a resident of
12 California for at least six months and of San Francisco County for at least three months
13 immediately preceding the filing of the Petition.

14 e. Within the Petition and Response, both parties request a divorce based on irreconcilable
15 differences.

16 f. On 10/13/25, Respondent filed a Declaration Regarding Service of Declaration of
17 Disclosure stating that Respondent's Preliminary Declaration of Disclosure was served
18 on the other party by mail on 8/30/25.

19 g. On 2/2/26, Petitioner filed a Declaration Regarding Service of Declaration of Disclosure
20 stating that Petitioner's Preliminary Declaration of Disclosure was served on the other
21 party by mail on 10/23/25.

22 h. In the Request for Separate Trial (attached to Respondent's 3/20/26 Request for Order),
23 Respondent responded to the prompt "All pension or retirement plans in which the
24 community has an interest are listed below" by listing the following:

25 i. 401(k) in Respondent's name administered by Alaska Airlines Fidelity

26 ii. Pension plan in Petitioner's name administered by the Western Conference of
27 Teamsters Pension Trust

28 4. Based on the foregoing, the Court finds good cause to CONTINUE Respondent's unopposed
29 request to bifurcate and terminate the parties' domestic partnership status as the pension plan in

Petitioner's name administered by the Western Conference of Teamsters Pension Trust must be joined in this action under Family Code section 2337(d) before the Court can bifurcate and terminate the parties' domestic partnership status. The Court notes the 401(k) in Respondent's name administered by Alaska Airlines Fidelity does not require joinder.

5. Accordingly, Respondent's unopposed request to bifurcate and terminate the parties' domestic partnership status is **CONTINUED to 7/14/26 at 9 AM in Dept. 403** to permit Respondent time to effectuate joinder of the pension plan (i.e., submit forms FL-370, FL-372, and FL-375 to effectuate joinder).
6. The Court will prepare the Findings and Order After Hearing.